

Pre-Listing Prep & Styling Checklist — Northern Territory

Getting your property market-ready without overspending on the wrong things.

Correct as at July 2026. General information only, not legal, financial or valuation advice.

Section 1 — Before You Spend Anything

- ☐ ☐ **Engage your conveyancer or solicitor early** to prepare your contract and disclosure documents.
- ☐ ☐ **Get a professional appraisal from 2-3 agents** before deciding your preparation budget.
- ☐ ☐ **Decide: renovate, style, or sell as-is?** Major renovations rarely return their cost dollar-for-dollar in a short pre-sale timeframe.

Section 2 — High-Return, Low-Cost Improvements

- ☐ ☐ **Declutter aggressively** — consistently the highest-return, lowest-cost step.
- ☐ ☐ **Deep clean throughout**, including often-overlooked areas.
- ☐ ☐ **Fix small, visible defects** — leaking taps, cracked tiles, chipped paint, and anything related to storm/cyclone wear given the NT's climate.
- ☐ ☐ **Service and check air conditioning systems before listing** — genuinely important in the NT's climate; buyers inspecting will notice and value confirmed, functioning cooling.
- ☐ ☐ **Check screens, seals, and drainage** for general storm-readiness, particularly if selling through the wet season.
- ☐ ☐ **Improve street appeal.**

Section 3 — Styling Decisions

- ☐ ☐ **Consider professional staging for vacant properties.**
- ☐ ☐ **For occupied properties, focus on de-personalising** rather than full staging.
- ☐ ☐ **Get professional photography and floor plans regardless of styling budget** — not an area to cut costs on.
- ☐ ☐ **Ask your agent for their honest opinion on styling ROI** for your specific property.

Section 4 — Compliance Items to Check Before Listing

- ☐ ☐ **Check smoke alarm compliance.**
- ☐ ☐ **If in a body corporate scheme, gather your records** — recent meeting minutes, financials, and any known disputes or special levies.
- ☐ ☐ **Address any known storm, structural, or pest issues honestly.**

Section 5 — Timing Your Campaign

- ☐ ☐ **Discuss timing with your agent relative to the NT's distinctive seasonal patterns** — the dry season (roughly May–October) is typically considered a stronger period for inspections and open homes in the Top End, given weather and comfort factors.
- ☐ ☐ **Align your preparation timeline with your agent's proposed campaign start.**
- ☐ ☐ **Consider highlighting HLPE or grant eligibility** if you're selling a house-and-land package or new-build property — this could be a genuine drawcard for buyer budgets.
- ☐ ☐ **Plan your own moving logistics in parallel** — see the separate Pre-Settlement Checklist in this series.

Quick Reference — Where to Spend, Where to Save

HIGH-RETURN, LOW-COST	OFTEN LOWER-RETURN RELATIVE TO COST
Decluttering	Full kitchen/bathroom renovations
Deep cleaning	High-end fixture upgrades
Minor repairs	Structural changes shortly before sale
Professional photography	Extensive landscaping overhauls
Air conditioning servicing	Full furniture replacement for occupied homes

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